enjoy their property and engage in business," and that "when * * * we speak of the corporation * * * contracting in the corporate name, etc., we are merely employing a short and convenient mode of describing the complex and peculiar process by which the benefits and burdens of the corporate members are worked out."

The concrete import of these views is that a corporation is more nearly a method than a thing, and that the law in dealing with a corporation has no need of defining it as a person or an entity, or even as an embodiment of functions, rights and duties, but may treat it as a name for a useful and usual collection of jural relations, each one of which must in every instance be ascertained, analyzed and assigned to its appropriate place according to the circumstances of the particular case, having due regard to the purposes to be achieved. A confirmation of the accuracy of this analysis of the corporate form is found in the fact that the word "corporation" has a variable, not a constant, meaning.

The rights and obligations that are comprised within the compass of the word change not only with time, but with locality. Limited liability of the shareholders is a comparatively recent invention. Limited and unlimited liability existed side by side, even within this State, under chapter 611 of the Laws of 1875. The extent of limited liability varies under different statutes. Corporations with no par stock are now quite common. Methods of transacting business, conditions under which dividends may be declared, and all the details of what are commonly known as corporate activity are actually different in different jurisdictions. Moreover, endless variants of those features may be conceived of without doing violence to the general designation "corporation." Indeed, the charter of the Ramapo Manufacturing Company itself — the corporation here under consideration — affords a striking illustration of the variants of powers, liabilities and duties which may be properly included in the corporate form.

I come, then, to ask the significance of the particular claim made before me by these trustees who wish it decreed that in their accounting they stop at the point where they have become directors of a corporation. I lay aside for the moment the fact of the identity of persons, although it is not, I think, to be wholly disregarded in the final outcome. What meaning has their statement that they are directors of a corporation? Is this directorate a form of immunity? Is this position something within a "veil?" It seems to me that no one of the purposes or functions legitimately included in the general scope of incorporation has any relevancy to an accounting by these trustees. If the testator considered it